Espresso and Brew Standards

Version 6. Effective August 1, 2026. Owner: Director of Coffee. Approved by the Leadership Team on July 13, 2026. Replaces version 5.

1 Dialing in

Dial in every grinder each morning before the café opens, and again whenever two shots in a row run outside the recipe's time range. Bring shots back into range by changing the grind, not the dose. Only a Shift Lead or a Level 3 barista may change a recipe's dose, by no more than 0.5 g and only for that day, recorded on the dial-in log. Weigh every espresso dose and yield on the bar scales.

2 Recipes

Shot times are counted from the moment the pump starts. Doses are ground coffee; yields are liquid in the cup.

Drink	Dose	Yield or water	Time	Water temperature
Signature Blend espresso, double	18.5 g	40 g	27–31 seconds	200°F (93.5°C)
Single-origin espresso, double	18 g	42 g	25–30 seconds	199°F (93°C)
Decaf espresso, double	18 g	38 g	28–33 seconds	201°F (94°C)
Batch brew, 2-liter batch	115 g	2,000 g water	5–6 minutes	200°F (93.5°C)
Batch brew, 1-liter half batch	60 g	1,000 g water	4–5 minutes	200°F (93.5°C)
Pour-over	22 g	350 g water	3:00–3:30 minutes	205°F (96°C)
Cold brew concentrate	1,000 g	6,000 g water	16–18 hours	Cold filtered water

3 Drink builds

Small (8 oz) and medium (12 oz) hot drinks get a double shot, and large (16 oz) hot drinks get a triple. Iced drinks get a double shot in every size. Cold brew is served as one part concentrate to one part water over ice, unless the guest asks for it stronger.

4 Milk

Steam milk to between 140°F and 155°F (60–68°C). "Extra hot" means up to 170°F (77°C), and kids' drinks are steamed to 120°F (49°C). Never steam the same milk twice. Latte foam is about 1 cm deep in the cup, and cappuccino foam about 2 cm.

5 Batch brew holding

Batch brew is held in its thermal server for no more than 30 minutes, then poured out, even if the server is still full. After 2:00 p.m., or whenever fewer than about 10 cups an hour are selling, brew half batches. Write each server's brew time on its tag.

6 Beans

Use espresso beans between 7 and 28 days after their roast date, and filter beans between 4 and 21 days after it. Beans past those windows can go into cold brew up to 45 days after roasting; after that they go back to the roastery on the next delivery truck. Fill hoppers with no more than one day's beans, and keep open bags folded and clipped.

7 Quality checks

A District Manager or Coffee Trainer checks each café's coffee every month: two shots from each grinder, and a batch brew measured with a refractometer. Batch brew should read 1.30–1.45% TDS. A café that falls outside a range at two checks in a row gets a visit from the Director of Coffee's team within 14 days.